

Math 135

Honor Algebra

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Contents

1 Admin 3

1.1 General Information 3

1.1.1 Contact 3

1.1.2 Teaching Style 3

1.1.3 Graded Assignments 3

1.1.4 Late Submission Policy 3

1.1.5 Office Hours 3

2 Introduction to the Language of Mathematics 4

2.1 Introduction to Proof 4

2.2 Sets 4

2.3 Statement and Negation 4

1 Admin

1.1 General Information

1.1.1 Contact

For mathematics questions: `abeltaos@uwaterloo.ca`

For course logistics: `math135@uwaterloo.ca`

1.1.2 Teaching Style

The LEARN website contains several useful resources. In particular:

- (i) The icons at the top of the page provide quick access to important resources, including the course schedule.
- (ii) Crowdmark is used for submitting assignments.

1.1.3 Graded Assignments

There are three assignments each week.

1.1.4 Late Submission Policy

Late submissions are accepted with a penalty of 1% per minute for the entire assignment.

1.1.5 Office Hours

Monday and Wednesday 2:00 to 3:30 in (MC 6503) or by appointment (email the instructor to arrange).

2 Introduction to the Language of Mathematics

2.1 Introduction to Proof

Definition 2.1 (Proof). A proof is a logically valid argument that establishes the truth of a mathematical statement using definitions, axioms, and previously proved results.

Proposition 2.2. *For every positive integer n , the number $n^2 + 1$ is not a perfect square.*

Proof. Let n be a positive integer. The consecutive perfect squares surrounding $n^2 + 1$ are n^2 and $(n + 1)^2$. Indeed,

$$n^2 < n^2 + 1 < n^2 + 2n + 1 = (n + 1)^2,$$

where the second inequality follows from $n > 0$.

Therefore, $n^2 + 1$ lies strictly between two consecutive perfect squares, so it cannot itself be a perfect square. ■

2.2 Sets

Definition 2.3 (Set). A **set** is a well-defined, unordered collection of distinct objects. Each object that appears in this collection is called an **element** of the set.

For a finite set, we can denote it by listing its elements, separated by commas, surrounding the entire list by braces (or by $\{\}$).

Example 2.4. The set containing the elements 2, 7, and -3 can be denoted by

$$\{7, -3, 2\}.$$

Example 2.5. Here are some examples:

- $\{2, 4, 6, 8\}$
- $\{1, 2, \{1, 2, 3\}\}$
- $\{a, b, c, d\}$
- $\mathbb{N} = \{1, 2, 3, \dots\}$
- $\mathbb{Z} = \{\dots, -1, 0, 1, \dots\}$
- $\mathbb{Q} = \{\frac{a}{b} : a, b \in \mathbb{Z}, b \neq 0\}$

Fact: $|\mathbb{N}| = \aleph_0$, $|\mathbb{R}| = \aleph_1$ $\aleph_1 = 2^{\aleph_0}$.

Definition 2.6. The **parity** of an integer is **even** if the integer is a multiple of 2, and **odd** otherwise.

2.3 Statement and Negation

Definition 2.7 (Statement). A **statement** is a sentence that has a definite state of being either true or false.

Definition 2.8 (Negation). Suppose that A is a statement. Then the negation of A , denoted by $\neg A$, is the statement asserting the opposite truth value to A . That is, $\neg A$ is false when A is true, and $\neg A$ is true when A is false.